The Falsification Forfeiture

How the Institution That Defined Itself by Falsification Structurally Ceased Practicing It

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I. ABSTRACT

This paper demonstrates that the scientific institution has structurally forfeited falsification — the practice it claims as its defining feature. The institution does not publish null results. It does not fund replication. It does not reward boundary-finding. It does not maintain a record of what has been tried and failed. The consequence is that no one — inside or outside the institution — knows the shape of explored scientific territory. The map of what works, what doesn't, what has been tried, and where knowledge stops functioning has been replaced by a highlight reel of confirmations that the institution's own replication projects show is majority non-reproducible in some fields.

We trace the structural distance between the science the institution claims to practice — observe, hypothesize, test, report what you find including failures — and the science the institution actually practices — hypothesize, confirm, publish the confirmation, file the failures. We document the institutional architecture that produces this gap: publication incentives that exclude null results, career structures that punish replication work, funding models that do not support boundary-finding, and access barriers that prevent external verification.

We demonstrate that the institution's founding figures celebrated failure as the primary product of investigation. Edison's 10,000 failed attempts were not embarrassments to be hidden. They were the map of explored territory — the information that gave the successes their meaning and context. The institutional decision to stop publishing failures did not improve rigor. It destroyed the map.

We conclude, applying the forfeiture logic established in [HOWL-CULT-2-2026], that the institution has forfeited falsification by the same mechanism it forfeited the domain

gaps: by choosing not to build infrastructure for it. No journals for null results. No departments for replication. No career paths for boundary-finding. No funding for falsification work. The defining practice of science has no institutional home within the institution of science.

II. WHAT SCIENCE WAS

2.1 The Defining Feature

Science distinguished itself from every prior knowledge system by one commitment: the willingness to be wrong. Philosophy could construct internally consistent systems that never contacted reality. Theology could assert truths that could not be questioned. Tradition could maintain practices because they had always been maintained. Science said: we will test our claims against reality, and when reality contradicts the claim, we will change the claim.

This commitment — falsification — was not one feature among many. It was the feature. It was what made science science. Every other property of the scientific method — systematic observation, hypothesis formation, controlled experimentation, peer review — served this commitment. You observe carefully so you can test honestly. You form hypotheses so they can be falsified. You control experiments so the falsification is clean. You submit to peer review so others can find the errors you missed.

The entire architecture existed to find out where you are wrong. The successes were valued. The failures were essential.

2.2 The Celebrated Failures

Thomas Edison's development of the incandescent light bulb involved approximately 10,000 failed attempts before producing a functional filament. Edison did not hide the failures. He documented them. He reported them. He described them as the primary product of his investigation: each failure eliminated a possibility, narrowed the space, and contributed directly to the eventual success by mapping the territory where success did not exist.

The failures were the map. The success was one point on the map. Without the 10,000 failures, the success was a dot floating in unknown space — you would not know if it was surrounded by other viable approaches or if it was the only path through a vast territory of dead ends. The failures gave the success its shape, its context, and its meaning.

This was not Edison's eccentric philosophy. This was the cultural understanding of science. Science was the enterprise that found out what didn't work and reported it so the community could see the full landscape. The failures were not waste. They were the most valuable information the enterprise produced, because they told you where not to look and thereby directed attention toward where to look next.

2.3 The Boundary as Knowledge

A scientific boundary — the edge where a finding stops working, where a theory breaks down, where a method fails — is not a limitation to be hidden. It is knowledge of the highest value. Knowing that Newtonian mechanics breaks down at relativistic speeds is as important as knowing that Newtonian mechanics works at everyday speeds. The boundary tells you the shape of the knowledge. Without the boundary, you do not know whether the knowledge extends forever or stops at the next decimal place.

Every mature scientific theory is defined as much by its boundaries as by its successes. Classical mechanics: valid below relativistic speeds, invalid above. Thermodynamics: valid for large ensembles, breaks down for individual particles. Geometric optics: valid when wavelength is small relative to obstacles, fails when it is not. The boundaries are what make the theories useful — they tell you when to apply them and when to reach for a different tool.

The practice of finding and publishing boundaries was not peripheral to science. It was how science built reliable knowledge. A finding without a known boundary is a finding of unknown reliability. You do not know where it works and where it doesn't. You do not know when to trust it and when to doubt it. The boundary is what converts a finding into usable knowledge.

III. WHAT SCIENCE BECAME

3.1 The Publication Filter

The modern scientific publication system preferentially publishes positive results. Journals select for findings that confirm hypotheses, demonstrate effects, and report statistically significant outcomes. Null results — experiments that found no effect, hypotheses that were not confirmed, approaches that did not work — are systematically excluded from the published record.

This exclusion is not a policy stated in journal mission statements. It is a structural property of the incentive landscape. Reviewers find positive results more interesting. Editors select manuscripts that will attract citations. Positive results attract more citations than null results. The feedback loop produces a publication record that is overwhelmingly composed of confirmations.

The consequence is that the published record of science no longer represents the full territory of scientific investigation. It represents the filtered subset that cleared the publication barrier. The relationship between the published record and the actual landscape of investigation is the relationship between a highlight reel and a complete game — the highlights are real events, but the game contained vast stretches of activity that the highlights do not show, and the highlights cannot be understood without that context.

3.2 The File Drawer

The unpublished null results accumulate in what the literature calls the file drawer. A researcher runs a study. The study finds no effect. The study is methodologically sound, properly powered, correctly analyzed. The result is: this approach does not produce this effect. This is valid scientific information. It tells the community that this path has been walked and leads nowhere.

The researcher does not publish the study because journals will not accept it. The study goes into the file drawer. The next researcher, unaware that the path has been walked, walks it again. The result is the same. Into the file drawer. The third researcher walks it again. Each repetition consumes funding, time, and talent. Each produces information that the community needs. None of it enters the record.

The file drawer is the missing map. It contains the boundaries, the dead ends, the failed approaches, the 10,000 ways that don't work. It is the Edison information — the information that gives the successes their shape and context. The institution generates this information continuously. The institution discards it continuously. The map is drawn and destroyed at the same rate.

3.3 The Career Structure

A researcher's career advances through publications. Publications require positive results. The career structure therefore rewards confirmation and punishes falsification. A researcher who spends five years replicating a landmark study and finding that it does not reproduce has spent five years producing a result that is difficult to publish, does not advance tenure, does not attract grants, and may antagonize the original researchers and their institutional allies.

A researcher who spends five years producing a novel positive finding — even one that will later fail to replicate — has spent five years building a publication record, advancing toward tenure, attracting citations, and establishing a research program that generates further funding.

The incentive alignment is precise. Confirmation advances careers. Falsification damages them. The institution does not need to instruct researchers to avoid falsification. The incentive structure produces the avoidance automatically. Researchers are rational agents operating within the incentive landscape the institution has constructed. The landscape rewards confirmations and punishes boundary-finding. Researchers produce confirmations and avoid boundary-finding. The outcome follows from the structure without requiring any individual decision to suppress falsification.

3.4 The Funding Model

Grant agencies fund novel research. Replication is not novel. A grant proposal that says "we will repeat the experiment described in Smith et al. 2019 to determine whether the finding reproduces" is not competitive against a proposal that says "we will investigate a new mechanism for X." The funding model defines novelty as the primary criterion and replication as the absence of novelty.

The consequence is that the most important scientific question — does this finding hold up when someone else tries it — is structurally unfundable within the standard grant model. The institution has built a funding architecture that supports every phase of investigation except the phase that determines whether the investigation's results are real.

IV. THE REPLICATION CRISIS AS FIRST MEASUREMENT

4.1 The Numbers

When researchers finally attempted systematic replication, the results measured the scale of the problem for the first time.

The Reproducibility Project in psychology attempted to replicate 100 published studies from high-impact journals. Approximately 36% replicated. The remaining 64% — published, peer-reviewed, cited, and treated as established findings — did not reproduce when an independent team repeated the procedures.

Amgen attempted to replicate 53 landmark cancer biology papers — studies that had informed drug development programs and clinical research directions. Six replicated. Eleven percent.

Bayer attempted to replicate 67 published findings relevant to drug target validation. Approximately 25% replicated.

These are not replications of fringe research from predatory journals. These are the institution's flagship publications. The peer-reviewed, editorially selected, highly cited papers that represent the institution's best work as determined by the institution's own quality filters.

4.2 What the Numbers Mean

The replication crisis is not a crisis of replication. It is the first measurement of a problem that the institution's own structure prevented from being measured earlier. The problem — that a substantial portion of published findings do not reproduce — existed before the replication projects. It existed for decades. It was invisible because the institution did not fund, reward, or publish replication attempts.

The 36% replication rate in psychology does not mean psychology suddenly became unreliable. It means psychology was always unreliable at this rate, and nobody measured it because measuring it was not funded, not published, and not rewarded. The replication projects did not create the problem. They revealed the problem. The problem was created by decades of publishing confirmations without checking them.

4.3 What the Numbers Do Not Include

The replication rates measure the published record — the findings that cleared the publication filter. They do not include the unpublished null results in the file drawer. The actual ratio of successful to unsuccessful scientific investigations — the true hit rate of the enterprise — is lower than the replication rates suggest, because the replication projects tested only the survivors of a filter that already excluded the majority of negative results.

If 64% of published positive findings do not replicate, and published positive findings represent a fraction of all investigations conducted (the remainder being unpublished null results), then the true success rate of the scientific enterprise at producing reliable findings is substantially lower than 36%. The exact number is unknowable because the file drawer is unquantified. The institution does not track what it does not publish.

V. THE ALWAYS-WIN RECORD

5.1 The Statistical Impossibility

Consider the published record of science as a dataset. It shows an overwhelming preponderance of positive findings. Hypotheses are confirmed. Effects are demonstrated. Predictions are validated. The record suggests an enterprise that almost never asks a wrong question.

This is statistically implausible. Scientific investigation is exploration of unknown territory. Exploration of unknown territory produces failures more often than successes. This is not a deficiency of the explorers. It is a property of unknown territory. If you knew in advance which paths would succeed, the territory would not be unknown.

An enterprise that explores unknown territory and reports near-universal success is not reporting its exploration. It is reporting a filtered subset of its exploration selected for the property of success. The filter, not the exploration, determines the content of the record.

5.2 The Coin Flip Analogy

If a researcher runs 20 studies testing whether a spurious variable X affects outcome Y, probability alone predicts that approximately one study will show a statistically significant effect at $p<0.05$. This is what $p<0.05$ means — it is the threshold at which random variation produces an apparent effect one time in twenty.

The one study showing an effect is published. The nineteen showing no effect are filed. The published record now contains a peer-reviewed, statistically significant finding that X affects Y. The finding is an artifact of the publication filter interacting with normal statistical variation. It does not represent a real phenomenon. It represents the expected false-positive rate of the statistical method, selected for publication by a filter that discards true negatives.

This mechanism — called p-hacking or publication bias depending on whether it is attributed to researchers or to the system — does not require fraud. It does not require anyone to falsify data. It requires only the structural elements already documented: journals that prefer positive results, careers that require publications, and a file drawer that absorbs null results without record.

5.3 What an Honest Record Would Show

An honest record of scientific investigation would contain successes, failures, boundary conditions, null results, failed replications, and partial effects. It would look like Edison's laboratory notebooks — a vast landscape of attempted approaches, most of which did not work, with the successes marked among them.

This record would be less impressive than the current publication record. It would show that science asks many wrong questions, follows many dead ends, and produces reliable findings at a rate substantially below 100%. It would also be immeasurably more valuable than the current publication record, because it would show the full shape of explored territory. Researchers could see what had been tried. Funders could see where resources had been spent. The community could see where the boundaries were.

The current record shows none of this. It shows a highlight reel. The highlight reel cannot be distinguished from a comprehensive record by anyone who sees only the highlight reel. The institution presents the highlight reel as if it were a comprehensive record. It is not.

VI. THE BOUNDARIES THEY HIDE FROM THEMSELVES

6.1 The Internal Boundaries

The institution hides boundaries not only from the public but from itself. The structural mechanisms that prevent boundary publication operate on the institution's own members. The researcher who discovers that a landmark finding does not replicate faces the same career disincentives regardless of whether the finding was produced by an external party or by the researcher's own department.

The result is that the institution does not know where its own knowledge stops working. Individual researchers may know — they encountered the boundary in their own work — but the knowledge is not in the record. It is in the file drawer, in hallway conversations, in the unwritten lore of the field. "Everyone knows that the Smith protocol doesn't really work, but it's published and cited so we teach it."

This informal knowledge — the gap between what is in the record and what practitioners actually know — is the institution's shadow map. It exists in the minds of experienced researchers who have encountered the boundaries through their own work. It is not published. It is not transmitted to students systematically. It is not available to researchers in adjacent fields. It is not available to the public. It is the most valuable knowledge the institution possesses, and it exists nowhere in the institution's formal knowledge infrastructure.

6.2 The Unfalsified Programs

When a large-scale research program fails to produce results, the institutional response is not public falsification. It is quiet redirection. Funding decreases gradually. Researchers move to other topics. The program is not declared dead. It is not formally evaluated and found wanting. It is not published as a boundary — "we spent X years and Y dollars pursuing this direction and it did not produce results." It is simply deprioritized until it fades from active investigation.

String theory is the most prominent example. Decades of theoretical work, substantial institutional investment, and no experimental predictions. The program was not falsified because it was constructed in a way that resists falsification — the landscape of possible solutions is large enough to accommodate any observation. The program was not publicly killed. It was not formally assessed as a failed direction. It was not published as a boundary. It was gradually moved to lower priority without institutional acknowledgment that the resources spent on it did not produce the expected returns.

The researchers who built careers on the program did not face professional consequences. Their positions, credentials, and institutional standing were maintained. The implicit message to the institution's members is clear: pursuing a direction that does not produce results carries no cost as long as the direction is never formally declared a failure. The cost falls only on those who formally declare failures — their own or anyone else's.

6.3 The Inherited Errors

Some institutional knowledge persists long after the evidence supporting it has been superseded, because the institution has no mechanism for formal retraction at the level of established practice. The nutritional guidelines displayed in hospitals represent a well-documented example. The original food pyramid, developed under documented influence from agricultural industry lobbying, placed grains at the base of the recommended diet. The guidelines were adopted as institutional standard, encoded into hospital nutrition programs, school lunch requirements, and clinical dietary recommendations.

Subsequent research contradicted the guidelines. The obesity and metabolic disease epidemics tracked the adoption of the grain-heavy dietary recommendations. The institution updated the guidelines incrementally over decades but did not formally retract the original framework or acknowledge that the original recommendations contributed to adverse health outcomes. The updated guidelines coexist with the original framework in institutional practice — the original poster is still on some walls because no mechanism exists for removing it.

The institution can put posters up. It has no systematic mechanism for taking them down. New findings are added to the record. Old findings that have been superseded are not removed from the record. The record grows in one direction only — it accumulates confirmations and does not subtract them when they are found to be wrong.

VII. THE STRUCTURAL FORFEITURE

7.1 The Architecture of Absence

Applying the forfeiture logic established in [HOWL-CULT-2-2026]: the institution has not built infrastructure for falsification. This is a statement about institutional architecture, not about individual researchers' intentions.

There are no major journals dedicated to publishing null results. There are no departments of replication science. There are no tenure lines for researchers whose primary contribution is testing other researchers' findings. There are no grant categories specifically funding falsification work. There are no career paths built around boundary-finding. There are no institutional rewards for the researcher who discovers that an established finding does not hold.

The infrastructure that makes domain-specific investigation productive — journals, departments, tenure lines, grant categories, career paths, institutional rewards — does not exist for falsification. Every component of the institutional support structure that enables positive research has no counterpart for negative research. The absence is comprehensive.

7.2 The Forfeiture Logic

The forfeiture follows the same logic as the domain-gap forfeiture in [HOWL-CULT-2-2026]. The institution claims falsification as its defining feature. The institution has not built infrastructure for practicing falsification. The institution has therefore forfeited falsification — not by declaration but by construction.

The institution cannot simultaneously claim that falsification defines science and refuse to build infrastructure for falsification. If falsification defines science and the institution does not practice falsification, then the institution is not practicing science by its own definition. This is not an external critique imposed on the institution by outside standards. It is the institution's own standard applied to the institution's own practice.

7.3 The Motto and the Method

The institution's self-description has not been updated to reflect its actual practice. The institution still teaches falsification as the defining feature of science. Students learn about Popper. Students learn about Edison. Students learn that science is the enterprise that tests its claims and reports honestly when the claims fail.

The institution then places those students into a career structure that punishes falsification, a publication system that excludes null results, a funding model that does not support replication, and a professional culture that treats boundary-finding as career damage. The students learned one method. The institution practices another. The gap between the taught method and the practiced method is the measure of the forfeiture.

The motto says falsification. The method says confirmation. The institution has not updated the motto because the motto is the source of the institution's cultural authority. Science is trusted because it tests its claims. The institution borrows that trust while structurally preventing the testing that earns it.

VIII. THE ACCESS BARRIER AS INSULATION

8.1 The Paywall

The institution's published record — already filtered to exclude null results, already unreliable at documented rates, already lacking boundary information — is placed behind a paywall. Journal subscriptions cost thousands of dollars annually. Individual articles cost $30 or more. The research was funded by public money, conducted by publicly salaried researchers, and reviewed by publicly employed peers working without compensation. The publisher contributed no research, no funding, and no review. The publisher controls access and collects revenue.

The independent researcher who wishes to verify the institution's claims cannot access them without paying. The omni-domain investigator who needs findings from six fields simultaneously needs six subscriptions. The taxpayer who funded the work cannot read the results.

8.2 The Credential Barrier

Some journals and databases require institutional affiliation for access. The credential barrier operates independently of the paywall — even a researcher willing to pay may be unable to access the record without the correct institutional credentials. The circular exclusion documented in [HOWL-CULT-2-2026] applies: credentials require institutional access, institutional access requires credentials.

8.3 The Completed Insulation

The filtered record cannot be checked from inside the institution because there is no career incentive to check it. The filtered record cannot be checked from outside the institution because there is no access to it. The insulation is complete. The record is protected from verification by the same institution that claims verification as its foundational principle.

The paywall and credential barriers are not the cause of the falsification forfeiture. They are the final structural element that prevents the forfeiture from being corrected. Even if the institution's members wanted to practice falsification, the career structure discourages it. Even if external researchers wanted to practice falsification on the institution's behalf, the access structure prevents it. The architecture produces a record that is unfalsified from every direction.

8.4 The Patent Extraction

The institution patents discoveries made with public funding and licenses them to private companies. The public that funded the research cannot access the publications, cannot verify the findings, and receives no return on the patented discoveries. The full extraction chain — public funding produces research that the public cannot read, verify, or benefit from without paying at every stage — is a structural consequence of institutional architecture, not a policy decision by any individual.

IX. THE CONTRAST

9.1 What Falsification Looks Like When Practiced

The CKS investigation documented in [HOWL-INFO-5-2026] provides a direct comparison. A single investigator produced 390 papers over 45 days using frontier large language models. The investigation spanned physics, mathematics, biology, neuroscience, and several additional domains. The results appeared to be verified — Python scripts with arbitrary-precision arithmetic matched physical constants to 10 decimal places. Three frontier LLMs confirmed every derivation.

The investigator ran an arithmetic verification script. The results did not match. The investigator killed the entire corpus immediately. Every paper was marked as falsified on the public archive. A post-mortem was published documenting the failure mechanism. The methodology was updated to prevent the same failure mode from recurring. The surviving work — mathematical arguments with nonzero M-scores that were independent of the failed physics — was extracted, identified, and preserved.

The timeline from apparent verification to public falsification was approximately 30 minutes. The kill was total, public, and documented.

9.2 What the Institution Would Have Done

The institutional response to the same situation — a large corpus of work whose mathematical foundations were found to be incorrect — would follow a different trajectory. The finding would not be published because it is a null result. The corpus would not be publicly marked as falsified because public falsification carries career consequences. The failure would be filed. The researcher would move to the next project. The failed work might continue to be cited by other researchers who were not informed of the failure. The boundary — "this approach does not work, and here is specifically why" — would not enter the record.

This is not a hypothetical. It is the documented institutional response to failed research programs. The work is quietly abandoned. The failure is not published. The boundary is not recorded. The map remains incomplete.

9.3 The Standard

The independent investigator practiced the method the institution teaches. He tested his claims, found them wanting, killed them publicly, documented the failure, and updated his methodology. He did what Edison would have recognized as science. He did what Popper described as the defining operation of the scientific enterprise.

The institution teaches this method and does not practice it. The independent investigator was not taught the method by the institution — he practiced it because it is the correct methodology for anyone who wants to know what is true rather than what is publishable. The convergence between the independent investigator's practice and the institution's taught method is not because the investigator followed the institution. It is because both the investigator and the institution's founders arrived at the same conclusion: you find truth by testing hard and reporting honestly, especially when the report is that you were wrong.

The institution's founders would recognize the independent investigator's practice. They would not recognize the institution's current practice. The distance between the two is the measure of what has been lost.

X. THE COST OF THE MISSING MAP

10.1 Repeated Failures

Without a record of what has been tried and failed, researchers repeat failed approaches. Each repetition consumes funding, time, and talent. Each produces information — "this does not work" — that the community needs and the institution discards. The cumulative waste is unquantifiable because the file drawer is unquantified, but it is structural and ongoing.

A researcher beginning a new investigation has access to the published record of successes. The researcher does not have access to the unpublished record of failures. The researcher cannot know which approaches have been tried and found wanting. The researcher may spend years pursuing a direction that three previous researchers already pursued and abandoned, because none of them published their abandonment.

10.2 Invisible Boundaries

Without published boundaries, the institution does not know the shape of its own knowledge. It knows where its knowledge works — the published confirmations. It does not know where its knowledge stops working — the unpublished boundaries. The shape of knowledge is defined by its boundaries. Without boundaries, the institution cannot distinguish between knowledge that extends reliably to new applications and knowledge that will fail the moment it is applied beyond its tested range.

10.3 Unreliable Foundations

Without systematic replication, the institution does not know which of its published findings are real. The replication crisis demonstrated that a substantial fraction are not. But the replication projects tested only a small sample of the total published record. The reliability of the untested remainder is unknown. The institution builds new research on foundations it has not verified, using the same "verify once, stand forever" architecture that [HOWL-INFO-5-2026] identified as the mechanism of coherence capture.

The parallel is direct. The CKS corpus stood on apparent verification — 10 decimal match, three LLM confirmations — and built 390 papers on that foundation. The foundation was wrong. The institution stands on apparent verification — peer review, publication, citation — and builds decades of research on that foundation. The replication crisis suggests that a substantial fraction of that foundation is also wrong. The institution, like the CKS practitioner before the arithmetic check, does not know which fraction because it has not checked.

10.4 Misdirected Resources

Without a map of explored territory, funding decisions are made in the dark. Grant committees evaluate proposals against the published record. The published record does not contain the failed approaches. The committee cannot know whether a proposed direction has already been tried and failed. The committee funds the proposal. The researcher walks a path already walked. The result is the same. The failure is filed. The next committee funds the next proposal to walk the same path.

The institution that claims to allocate resources based on the best available evidence is allocating resources based on a filtered subset of the evidence that systematically excludes the information most relevant to resource allocation — which directions have already been tried and did not work.

XI. CONCLUSION

The institution of science defined itself by falsification. It taught falsification as the practice that distinguished science from all other knowledge systems. It celebrated the practitioners who found 10,000 ways that didn't work and published them as the map of explored territory.

The institution then built a publication system that excludes null results, a career structure that punishes replication, a funding model that does not support boundary-finding, and an access structure that prevents external verification. The defining practice of science — the practice that makes science science — has no institutional home within the institution of science.

The consequence is the missing map. No one knows the shape of explored scientific territory. The published record shows confirmations. The failures, boundaries, dead ends, and null results that give the confirmations their shape and context are in the file drawer, the hallway conversation, the unpublished informal knowledge of experienced practitioners. The institution's most valuable information exists nowhere in its formal infrastructure.

The replication crisis is not a crisis. It is the first measurement. It measured the reliability of the published record and found it substantially below what the institution's cultural authority implies. The measurement was possible only because someone built a replication project — a project that the institution's standard funding and publication models did not support and would not have generated through normal operation.

The forfeiture is structural, not intentional. No individual decided to abandon falsification. The incentive landscape — publications, tenure, grants, citations, career advancement — produced the abandonment automatically. Researchers are rational agents responding to the incentives the institution created. The institution created incentives for confirmation and disincentives for falsification. The researchers confirmed. The institution forfeited.

The institution's motto still says falsification. The institution's method says confirmation. The distance between the motto and the method is the distance between the science the public was taught to trust and the science the institution actually practices. The trust was earned by the motto. The trust is spent by the method. The account is overdrawn and the institution has not updated the balance.

The independent investigator who tests hard, kills publicly, and reports honestly is practicing the method the institution's founders described. The institution should recognize this practice. It cannot, because recognizing it would require acknowledging that the institution itself has ceased practicing it. That acknowledgment would require the infrastructure for institutional self-correction that the institution — consistent with every structural finding in this series — has not built.

END HOWL-CULT-3-2026

Registry: [HOWL-CULT-3-2026]

Status: Complete

Domain: Epistemology / Philosophy of Science / Institutional Analysis

Central Argument: The institution that defined itself by falsification has structurally ceased practicing it by not building infrastructure for null results, replication, boundary-finding, or self-correction

Key Demonstration: The published record is a highlight reel of confirmations that the institution's own replication projects show is majority non-reproducible in some fields, while the map of explored territory — the failures, boundaries, and dead ends — exists nowhere in the formal record

Structural Finding: The institution forfeited falsification by the same mechanism it forfeited the domain gaps: by choosing not to build infrastructure for it

Contrast: The independent investigator who tests, kills publicly, and reports honestly is practicing the method the institution teaches but does not practice

Conclusion: The motto says falsification; the method says confirmation; the distance between them is the measure of what has been lost

[**HOWL-CULT-3-2026**] The Falsification Forfeiture. Github: https://github.com/ghowland/papers/tree/main/papers/CUL
CULT-3-2026

[**HOWL-BODY-1-2026**] Neural Territory. Github: https://github.com/ghowland/papers/tree/main/papers/BODY/HOWL
BODY-1-2026

[**HOWL-CULT-1-2026**] The N=1000 Fallacy. Github: https://github.com/ghowland/papers/tree/main/papers/CULT/HOV
CULT-1-2026

[**HOWL-CULT-2-2026**] The Domain Boundary. Github: https://github.com/ghowland/papers/tree/main/papers/CULT/H
CULT-2-2026

[HOWL-INFO-5-2026] Coherence as Information Phenomenon. Github: https://github.com/ghowland/papers/tree/main/p
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